

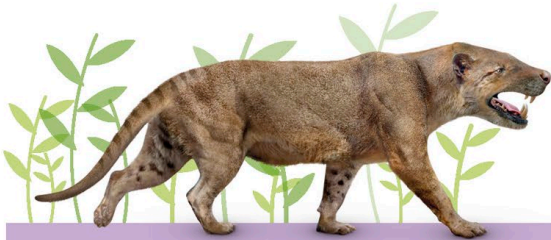
April

18

2019

Ancient carnivore

An ancient mammal species bigger than a polar bear was identified. The 22-million-year-old bones of *Simbakubwa kutokaafrika* had lain forgotten in a drawer at Nairobi National Museum, Kenya, for nearly 40 years.



Also on this day

1775 US patriot Paul Revere rode through the night to alert the US militia about an impending attack by British troops.

1906 A 7.9-magnitude earthquake struck San Francisco, USA, destroying much of the city and killing more than 3,000 people.

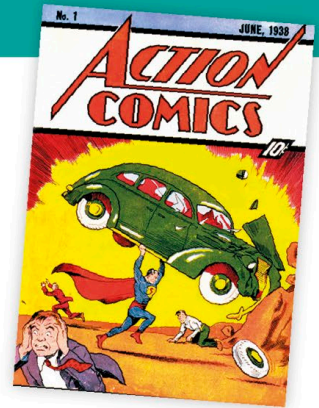
2018 Cinemas reopened in Saudi Arabia after a 35-year ban. Marvel's *Black Panther* was the first movie to be screened.

1938

Here comes Superman!

Comic book legend Superman appeared for the first time in *Action Comics* #1.

Created by US writer and artist duo Jerry Siegel and Joe Shuster, Superman was the first comic book hero to have superpowers.



Born this day

1813 James McCune Smith, Black American physician. Born into slavery, he became the first Black person in the USA to earn a medical degree.

St Peter's Basilica

1506

In Rome, Italy, Pope Julius II laid the foundation stone of the new St Peter's Basilica. The enormous stone church was designed by architect Donato Bramante, whose work was continued after his death by other artists, including Michelangelo and Raphael. It took 150 years to build.

